



BREAKING · FENWICK GROVE

Hand-Knitted Cup Cosies Found Looped Over Bike Racks Citywide, Risk Assessed Low

Case definition: any tea-cup-sized knitted cosy, granny-square pattern, found looped over a bike rack or lamppost handle with no note attached. Fourteen spotted as of Thursday along the Fenwick Grove greenway alone, up from a single unclaimed example left outside the library. The neighbourhood association's working theory (a guerrilla knitting circle, likely retirees, likely proud of it) remains unconfirmed. Nobody has been rude enough to unravel one and check.

Community Outbreak Bulletin

BUSINESS · MARKETS

Held The Short Two Days Past The Point Of Comfort

Sherman McCoy

Everyone told me to cover by Tuesday. I covered Thursday, alone in the kitchen at 6am in yesterday's polo, watching the number do exactly what I'd said it would three days too early to prove it. Marshall sat by the door the whole time, unimpressed, the way he gets when I talk to the terminal like it can hear me. It can't. I still won by four points. Judy didn't ask this time. I told her anyway.

CANON VIGNETTE

The Console Nobody Reset Properly

Luke Skywalker

Found the old training remote still active in a supply crate nobody had inventoried since the last owner moved on. Ran the blast-shield drill blind, out of habit more than need, missed twice, hit the third clean. Some things you keep testing long after there's anyone left to grade you on it.



MARKETS · THE PEARL INDEX

Con-Weekend Correlation, Closed Out: The Badge Bump Was Real

Final tally against $n=612$ (up from the provisional $n=210$ two issues back): counters within four blocks of the convention centre finished the weekend 12% above trend ($\pm 3.6\%$ MOE), holding above the earlier provisional read once the full dataset came in. Outside that radius, no meaningful lift at all, flat to trend within margin. So: a real, geographically tight badge bump, not a citywide one, and not the seasonal noise I hedged against last issue. I said I had a badge and a conflict of interest. I still do. The data didn't need my badge to be honest, and neither did I.

Priya Anand, The Pearl Index

WEATHER · EPIC FORECAST

The First Real Warm One, And I Don't Trust It

Dana Foley

Twenty-one degrees by early afternoon, the first genuine spring number all month, and I want it on record that I do not trust a single degree of it. Fronts this time of year love nothing more than a good first impression before the follow-up cold snap. Enjoy the jacket-off hour. Keep the jacket within reach.

BUBBLE TEA TRIVIA · DID YOU KNOW?

Two Shops, One Unresolved Rivalry

Chun Shui Tang in Taichung and Hanlin Tea Room in Tainan have spent decades in genuine, unresolved dispute over which one actually invented bubble tea first, both dating their claim to the early 1980s.



In Every Issue

A new logic puzzle

Fresh local trivia

A rotating cast of columnists

Local ad space, weekly

Menace Watch, monthly — the editor's turn

"I said I had a badge and a conflict of interest. I still do."

— Priya Anand, The Pearl Index, closing out the con-weekend numbers

JOKE OF THE WEEK

Why did the tapioca pearl get promoted? It really knew how to roll with things.



Toyota — Let's Go Places (Off-Ramp Edition)

"You already see us at every intersection in Auckland. Today, apparently, you see us here too."

Parody ad box only, not a real Toyota placement, not affiliated with or endorsed by Toyota Motor Corporation.



LIFESTYLE · CHAMPAGNE WISHES

Inside A Herne Bay Spring Ball, Where The Marquee Cost More Than The House Next Door

Champagne wishes and caviar dreams, darlings, and this week they arrive under a marquee with its own chandelier, hired for one evening, at a cost the host's own accountant reportedly refused to say aloud twice. Two hundred guests, four ice sculptures (one already melting sideways by the time I arrived), and a string quartet flown in specifically because the local one, apparently, "read wrong for the light." Champagne wishes, caviar dreams, and now, apparently, weather-appropriate string quartets too.

Robin Leach

KISS & TELL

Darling, The Spring Ball Had A Second Guest List

The Stickybeak

Word from your Stickybeak: that marquee ball everyone's still talking about had a quiet second guest list, loves, the kind that gets you through a side entrance and a considerably better glass of champagne. Sources close to the ice sculptures confirm at least three uninvited guests worked it out simply by wearing better shoes than the caterers. The rivalry for that side entrance, my dears, was fiercer than anything happening inside.

DOMESTIC DESK

The First Mow Of The Season, Same As Every Season

Sebastian

Grass came in fast this year, the way it always claims to and never quite proves. Sebastian pushed the mower in straight lines nobody would measure, the way he has pushed it every spring for longer than the mower itself has existed in its current form. He remembers other springs. He remembers, more precisely, that remembering them changes nothing about the line he is currently walking.



PUZZLE OF THE WEEK

Which Size Did Ana Actually Order?

Last week's Evening Shift question, resolved: Kiri couldn't work mornings, and Percy's shift had to fall immediately after Nadia's, which only leaves Nadia on mornings, Percy at midday and Kiri closing. Kiri worked the evening shift.

Three regulars placed orders within a minute of each other this week (Ana, Bo, Cy), each a different size:

1. Bo didn't order the large.
2. Cy's order sat one size up from Ana's.

Brisk one this week · which size did Ana actually order? Answer next week — Ken Endo

Your Ad Here

Reach Fenwick Grove's bubble tea regulars for less than the price of a large taro.

IN MEMORIAM

The Punch Card Loyalty Stamp, Retired For An App

Skeleton

Fenwick Grove's corner counter has, this week, retired its ink-stamped loyalty card for a QR-linked app account. I confess nothing about the drawer of stamped-out cards still in my desk, four stamps shy of free drinks that will now never be redeemed. Mourn the card if sentiment moves you. Its replacement tracks considerably more about you than a stamp ever did, and I, for one, appreciate the honesty of that trade.

ASK THE CAPTAIN

New To The Neighbourhood And Nobody's Waved Back Yet

Horatio McCallister

"I moved to Fenwick Grove last month and I still don't know anyone on my own street." New to the water, a harbour doesn't introduce itself to a new boat either, lad. Ye tie up, ye wait out a few tides, ye offer the first wave twice before ye judge the second one withheld. Give it past the first month. Fair winds.

SHOPPING · SEEKER'S EYE

One Listing Ships The Actual Weight, Forty Don't

Winnie Zhao

Everyone hunting a "chunky knit throw blanket" this week wades through the same forty near-identical listings: same staged photo, same countdown banner resetting on refresh. One listing, buried three pages deep, actually ships the yarn weight the photo promises instead of a thin imitation dressed up under studio lighting. I've watched enough Snitches vanish from queues to know the real one when it finally sits still.

RURAL · RIDGELINE WEEKLY

First Lambs Counted, Doyle Ahead By A Nose

Clem Whitlock

Doyle's tally ticked over first this week, three sets of twins down before Higgins had his first single on the ground. Higgins isn't worried, mind, reckons his ewes are just running a fashionably late season. Down in town they're excited about a knitted cup cosy on a bike rack; out here, a live lamb count is still the only tally that matters.

HAYAKU · SECOND APPEARANCE

Art pending this issue. A new four-panel gag wasn't ready in time, so no repeat of Issue 9's debut art runs here. Placeholder text only; the panel returns with fresh art next time Hayaku is up.

Hayaku — an original senkotsu-style volleyball manga strip, Bubble Tea News's syndicated cartoon slot; alternates with The Boba Side.